

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

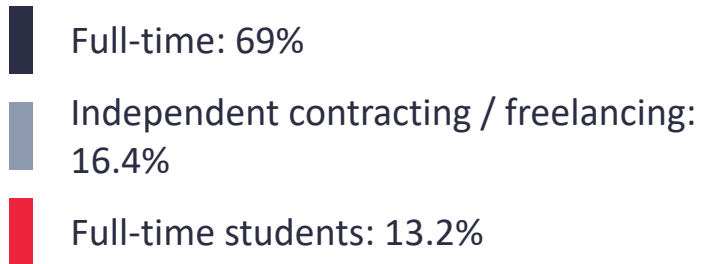
2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

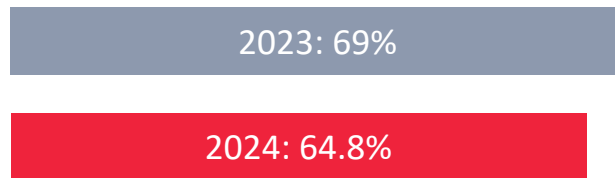
84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global Employment Status



84% of 65,437 respondents are currently working (full-time, part-time, or freelancing).

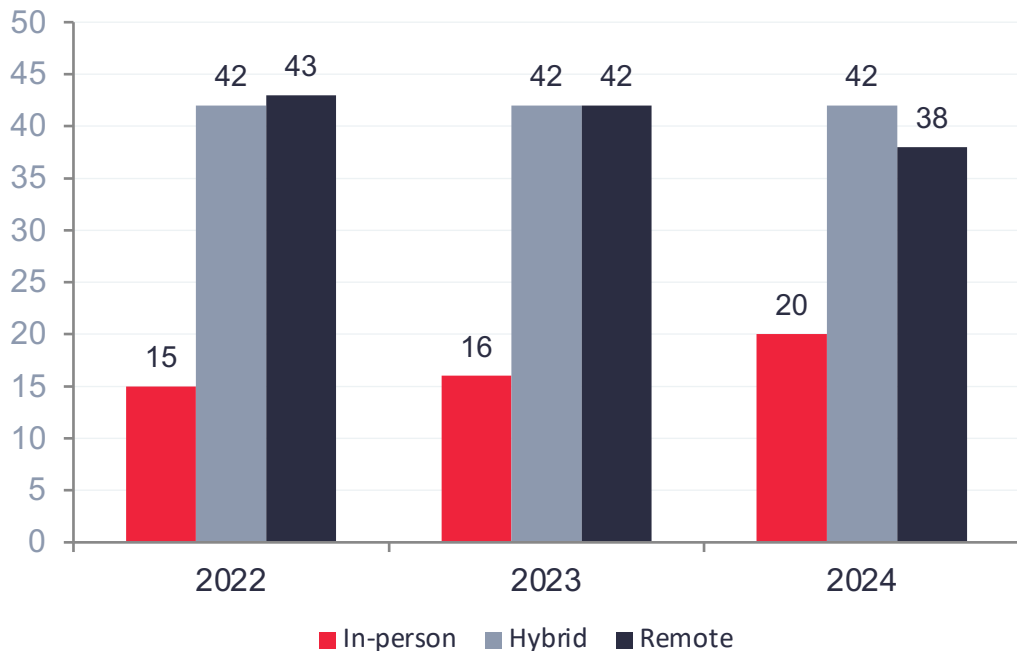
U.S. Full-Time Employment Shift



▼ 4.2 pp

Regional patterns: U.K. and Ukraine lean toward independent contracting; Germany and India see more full-time students.

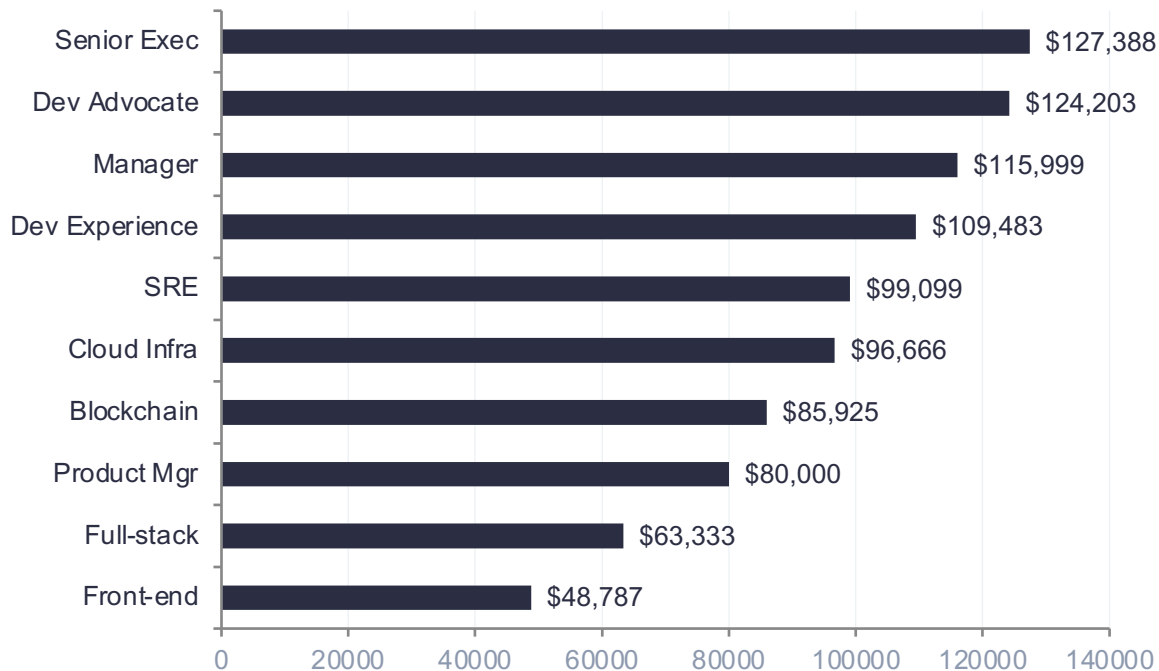
In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



Key Insights

- Hybrid remains the most common arrangement at 42%, unchanged from 2023.
- Remote work declined from 43% (2022) to 38% (2024).
- In-person work rose for the third consecutive year — 15% → 16% → 20%.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Top Earners

Senior Executive
\$127,388 | ~17 yrs

Dev Advocate
\$124,203 | ~16 yrs

Manager
\$115,999 | ~15 yrs

SREs and Cloud Infra Engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Pattern

Senior roles cluster in the upper-right: 14+ years of experience correlate with six-figure median salaries. Student is a clear outlier at ~2 years and \$15K.

Key Insight

DevRel and leadership roles command premium pay — all top three roles average 15+ years of experience.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Top Earners

Erlang: ~\$97,000 | ~12 yrs

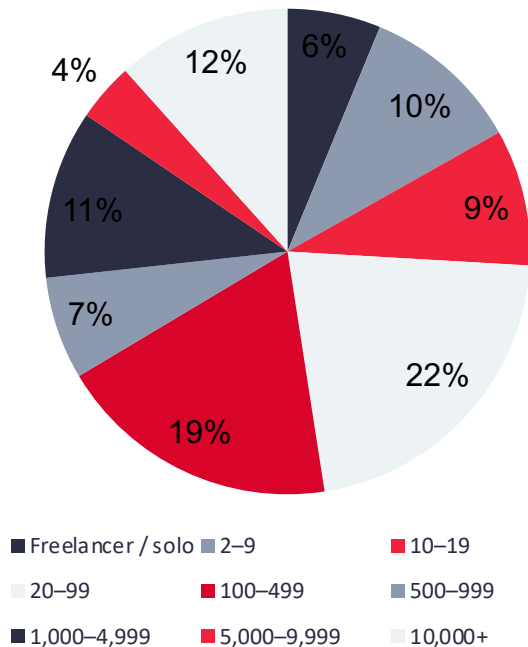
Clojure: ~\$95,000 | ~11 yrs

Elixir: ~\$93,000 | ~11 yrs

Context

Overall reported salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023, now averaging \$60–75K (was \$70–85K). Niche functional languages still command a premium.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



Technology Purchasing Influence

62

%

of respondents influence technology purchases at their organizations

Senior executives: 99%

Engineering managers: 87%

Product managers: 77%

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach.

Top evaluation methods: free trial (75%) and peer recommendations (73%).

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- 01 Full-time employment is softening — plan for more contractors. U.S. full-time dropped 4 pp YoY; freelancing remains significant at 16.4%.
- 02 In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates at 42%. Expect continued RTO pressure as in-person climbs from 15% to 20%.
- 03 DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay. Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Managers (\$116K) top the chart.
- 04 Language choice correlates with pay. Niche functional languages (Erlang, Clojure, Elixir) earn >\$93K; mainstream JS/PHP sit well below \$65K.
- 05 Most developers influence purchasing — 62% have a say in tech buying. Vendor strategies should target ICs directly, not just management.